

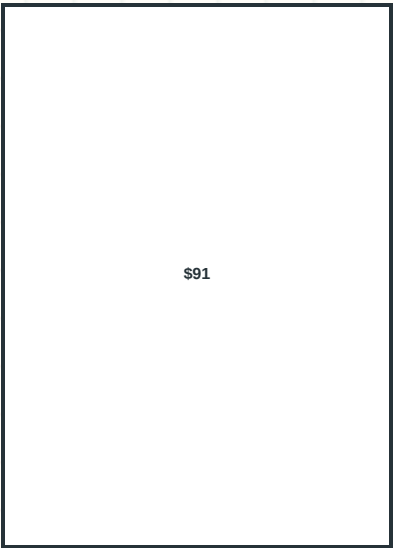
File Box Story Turning Point Card Pack

Sixteen file-box cards help writers connect a starting scene, a turn signal, a before path, an after path, a character reaction, and a next step.

Audience: Families, homeschool groups, tutors, and adult-led writing tables for writers ages 7-11.

Format: 16 printable file box story turning-point cards plus adult guide tools, turning-point routines, take-home turning slips, and optional adult prompts

Family-safe printable writing pages for adult-led, offline turning point practice.



\$91

Included

- 16 printable file box turning point cards
- Adult setup guide
- Fictional turning-point safety notes
- Starting scene prompts
- Turn signal prompts
- Before and after path prompts
- Character reaction prompts
- Next step prompts
- Six adult-led turning-point routines
- Ten take-home turning slips
- Printable PDF and ZIP artifact

Turning point coaching

File Box Turning Point Adult Guide

- Adult-led setup: place the file box, blank pages, pencils, and one turning point card on the table before the writer begins: _____.
- Adult-led framing: choose one fictional starting scene and keep every page paper-only, offline, and invented: _____.
- Adult-led order: move from starting scene to turn signal, before path, after path, reaction, next step, and file-box label: _____.
- Adult-led support: let the writer write or dictate short fictional lines while the adult keeps the file box sorted: _____.
- Adult-led safety: use pretend characters, broad places, and invented actions instead of real names, exact places, or personal facts: _____.
- Adult-led close: reread the turning point, add the next-step note, and write one file-box label for the paper stack: _____.

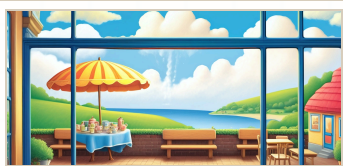
Use one file box card at a time. Keep every change broad, invented, paper-only, and guided by an adult.

Sixteen turning card worlds

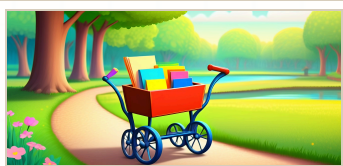
Pick a world image, then connect what came before, what changed, and what follows next.



AGES 7-9
Acorn Avenue Errand Office



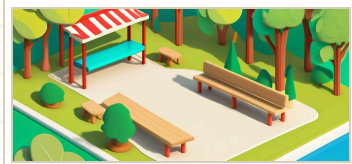
AGES 7-8
Teacup Town Weather Window



AGES 7-9
Sticker Station Mail Cart



AGES 7-9
Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor



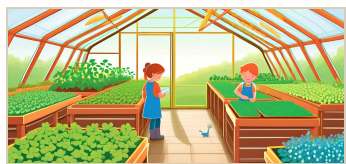
AGES 7-9
Pocket Park Notice Board



AGES 7-9
Rain Boot Route Rangers



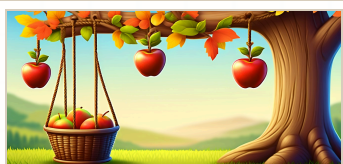
AGES 8-10
Tidepool Timekeepers Lab



AGES 8-10
Greenhouse Gear Garden



AGES 8-10
Solar Oven Picnic Station



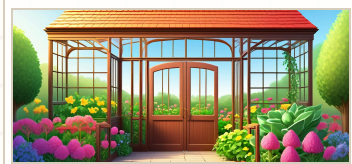
AGES 8-10
Orchard Pulley Post



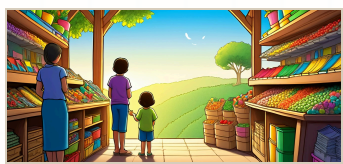
AGES 10-11
Revision River Ferry



AGES 10-11
Clue Label Tower Museum



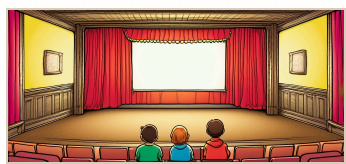
AGES 10-11
Chapter Gate Greenhouse



AGES 10-11
Margin Note Market



AGES 10-11
Binding Day Boardwalk



AGES 10-11
Index Card Theater Club

Choose the file box routine

SHORT FIRST-PAGE SETUP Starting Scene File Card File box, blank page, pencil, and starting scene card. 1. The adult opens the file box and points to the starting scene blank: _____. 2. The writer names one fictional place where the page begins: _____. 3. The adult asks what the character is doing before anything changes: _____. 4. The writer writes or dictates one starting scene line on paper: _____. This paper turning point starts in this fictional scene: _____.	PAPER CHANGE CUE Turn Signal Slip File box, starting scene page, turn signal slip, and pencil. 1. The adult rereads the starting scene line from the paper page: _____. 2. The writer invents one turn signal that shows the story is about to change: _____. 3. The adult asks what the character notices when the turn signal appears: _____. 4. The writer writes the turn signal on the slip and places it beside the page: _____. The turn signal changes the paper plan with: _____.
BEFORE-THE-TURN PASS Before Path Sort File box, starting scene page, before path note, and pencil. 1. The adult points to what the character expected before the turn signal: _____. 2. The writer names the before path the character thought would happen: _____. 3. The adult asks which paper line belongs before the turning point: _____. 4. The writer writes the before path note and files it behind the starting scene: _____. The before path on this paper plan is: _____.	AFTER-THE-TURN PASS After Path Sort File box, turn signal slip, after path note, and pencil. 1. The adult slides the turn signal slip between the before path and the blank after path: _____. 2. The writer invents what changes after the turn signal: _____. 3. The adult asks how the after path is different from the before path: _____. 4. The writer writes the after path note and places it after the turn signal: _____. The after path changes the fictional page by: _____.
REACTION LINE PASS Character Reaction Note File box, before path note, after path note, reaction note, and pencil. 1. The adult lays the before path and after path notes side by side: _____. 2. The writer names how the fictional character reacts to the change: _____. 3. The adult asks what the reaction shows in one paper line: _____. 4. The writer writes the character reaction note and tucks it after the after path: _____. The character reaction after the turning point is: _____.	FILE-BOX WRAP Next-Step File-Box Close File box, page stack, next-step slip, file-box label strip, and pencil. 1. The adult rereads the starting scene, turn signal, before path, after path, and reaction: _____. 2. The writer chooses one fictional next step that follows the turning point: _____. 3. The adult asks what file-box label will help find this paper turning point later: _____. 4. The writer writes the next-step slip and file-box label, then the adult files the stack: _____. The file-box label closes this turning point as: _____.

Try one turn later

TAKE-HOME TURNING SLIP Turning slip 1 Adult: set out one paper page and ask for a paper-only fictional starting scene: _____.	TAKE-HOME TURNING SLIP Turning slip 2 Writer: the paper-only fictional starting scene in my file box is: _____.
TAKE-HOME TURNING SLIP Turning slip 3 Adult: ask what paper-only fictional turn signal changes the plan: _____.	TAKE-HOME TURNING SLIP Turning slip 4 Writer: the paper-only fictional turn signal is: _____.
TAKE-HOME TURNING SLIP Turning slip 5 Adult: ask what paper-only fictional path the character expected before the turn signal: _____.	TAKE-HOME TURNING SLIP Turning slip 6 Writer: the paper-only fictional before path is: _____.
TAKE-HOME TURNING SLIP Turning slip 7 Adult: ask what paper-only fictional path changes after the turn signal: _____.	TAKE-HOME TURNING SLIP Turning slip 8 Writer: the paper-only fictional after path is: _____.
TAKE-HOME TURNING SLIP Turning slip 9 Adult: ask how the paper-only fictional character reacts and what next step follows: _____.	TAKE-HOME TURNING SLIP Turning slip 10 Writer: the paper-only fictional next-step note and file-box label are: _____.

- Optional adult prompts**
- Optional adult-led paper prompt: the fictional starting scene is _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the turn signal appears when _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the before path was supposed to _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the after path changes into _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the fictional character reacts by _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the next step on paper is _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the file-box label should say _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the next file-box card could begin with _____.

Acorn Avenue Errand Office Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one file box, blank page, pencil, and pretend errand-office turning point card beside the writer: _____.

Writer: keep the Acorn Avenue helper, errand slips, and office counter invented while the page turns on paper only: _____.



Acorn Avenue Errand Office

Starting scene
Start scene: write who is at the pretend errand office and what small paper slip starts the page:

Turn signal
Turn signal: write the label, stamp mark, or folded slip that tells the helper the errand page is changing:

Before path
Before path: write what the helper thought would happen before the turn signal appeared:

After path
After path: write the calmer new paper path the helper can follow after noticing the turn signal:

Character reaction
Character reaction: write how the helper responds to the change with one invented action or thought:

Next step
Next step: write the next paper-only move the helper makes at the errand office: _____

File-box label
File-box label: write a broad file-box label for this Acorn Avenue turning point: _____

Quiet option: fill only the start scene, turn signal, and file-box label blanks before adding the paths later: _____. Take-home line: reopen this paper turning point later with one pretend Acorn Avenue errand slip: _____.

Teacup Town Weather Window Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one file box, blank page, pencil, and pretend weather-window turning point card on the table: _____.

Writer: invent the teacup window, tiny weather sign, and helper so every detail stays on paper: _____.



Teacup Town Weather Window

Starting scene Start scene: write who watches the pretend window and what weather sign is first on the page: _____ _____	Turn signal Turn signal: write the small window clue that changes what the helper thinks the sign means: _____ _____
Before path Before path: write the simple plan the helper had before the window clue changed: _____ _____	After path After path: write the new paper path the helper follows after the weather-window signal: _____ _____
Character reaction Character reaction: write one gentle response the helper has when the window sign changes meaning: _____ _____	Next step Next step: write what the helper writes, folds, or checks next on the pretend page: _____ _____
File-box label File-box label: write a broad file-box label for this Teacup Town turning point: _____ _____	

Quiet option: draw a tiny window mark, then fill the turn signal and file-box label blanks: _____. **Take-home line:** continue this paper turning point later with one pretend teacup-window sign: _____.

Sticker Station Mail Cart Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set one file box, blank page, pencil, and pretend sticker-cart turning point card where the writer can reach them: _____.

Writer: keep the mail cart, sticker slips, and station helper completely invented while the turn stays on paper: _____.



Sticker Station Mail Cart

Starting scene Start scene: write which helper rolls the pretend cart in and which sticker slip starts the page: _____ _____	Turn signal Turn signal: write the sticker shape, color word, or cart tag that changes the helper's paper plan: _____ _____
Before path Before path: write where the helper thought the sticker slip belonged before the turn signal: _____ _____	After path After path: write the new paper path the helper follows after reading the cart tag again: _____ _____
Character reaction Character reaction: write how the helper reacts when the sticker clue points to a new idea: _____ _____	Next step Next step: write the next sticker slip, cart mark, or note the helper adds to the page: _____ _____
File-box label File-box label: write a broad file-box label for this Sticker Station turning point: _____ _____	

Quiet option: fill only the start scene, before path, and file-box label blanks before the after path: _____. **Take-home line:** start another paper turning point later with one pretend sticker-cart signal: _____.

Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one file box, blank page, pencil, and pretend spoon-ferry turning point card beside the paper: _____.

Writer: Invent the harbor, spoon ferry, lunchbox tag, and helper while every move stays paper-only: _____.



Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor

Starting scene
Start scene: write who waits near the pretend spoon ferry and what lunchbox tag starts the page:

Before path
Before path: write the harbor path the helper expected before the tag flipped or the dock mark changed:

Character reaction
Character reaction: write one calm response the helper has when the harbor plan changes:

File-box label
File-box label: write a broad file-box label for this Spoon Ferry turning point: _____

Turn signal
Turn signal: write the dock mark, ferry bell word, or tag flip that changes the harbor plan:

After path
After path: write the new paper path the helper follows after the spoon-ferry signal: _____

Next step
Next step: write the next dock note, ferry mark, or file box slip the helper adds: _____

Quiet option: fill the turn signal and after path blanks, then choose a file-box label later: _____. **Take-home line:** reopen this paper turning point later with one pretend spoon-ferry harbor signal: _____.

Pocket Park Notice Board Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one file box, blank page, pencil, and pretend notice-board turning point card: _____.

Writer: keep the pocket park, board notes, pins, and helper invented while the turning point stays on paper: _____.



Pocket Park Notice Board

Starting scene Start scene: write who reads the pretend board note and what park detail is first on the page: _____ _____	Turn signal Turn signal: write the pin color, paper corner, or board note that changes what the helper understands: _____ _____
Before path Before path: write the first idea the helper had before the board note changed the page: _____ _____	After path After path: write the new paper path the helper can follow after checking the notice board again: _____ _____
Character reaction Character reaction: write one invented response the helper has when the board note changes the plan: _____ _____	Next step Next step: write the next note, pin mark, or folded slip the helper adds to the pretend page: _____ _____
File-box label File-box label: write a broad file-box label for this Pocket Park turning point: _____ _____	

Quiet option: fill only the start scene, character reaction, and file-box label blanks for now: _____. **Take-home line:** continue this paper turning point later with one pretend pocket-park board note: _____.

Rain Boot Route Rangers Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one file box, blank page, pencil, and pretend rain-boot ranger turning point card beside the writer: _____.

Writer: invent the ranger, boot marks, and paper trail so the whole turning point stays pretend: _____.



Rain Boot Route Rangers

Starting scene
Start scene: write which ranger finds the first pretend boot mark and what it seems to mean:

Turn signal
Turn signal: write the rain-boot mark, folded trail slip, or sign word that changes the paper path:

Before path
Before path: write the route idea the ranger had before the turn signal appeared: _____.

After path
After path: write the new paper path the ranger follows after reading the boot mark again:

Character reaction
Character reaction: write how the ranger responds when the pretend route changes:

Next step
Next step: write the next boot mark, trail note, or file box slip the ranger adds: _____.

File-box label
File-box label: write a broad file-box label for this Rain Boot Route Rangers turning point:

Quiet option: fill the before path and after path blanks, then let the adult hold the file box for later: _____, **Take-home line:** restart this paper turning point later with one pretend rain-boot route signal: _____.

Tidepool Timekeepers Lab Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out a file box, blank page, pencil, and label strip before the paper turning point begins: _____.

Writer: invent a tidepool timekeeper, a pretend chart, and a made-up turn that stays on paper: _____.



Tidepool Timekeepers Lab

Starting scene
Start scene: write what the timekeeper is checking on the pretend tidepool chart before anything changes:

Before path
Before path: write what the timekeeper was going to do before noticing the turn signal:

Character reaction
Character reaction: write how the timekeeper reacts when the after path makes more sense:

File-box label
File-box label: write the short pretend label for this tidepool turning point: _____

Turn signal
Turn signal: name the paper clue that tells the timekeeper the plan needs a turn, such as a shell mark or clock dot: _____

After path
After path: write the new paper path the timekeeper follows after the signal changes the plan:

Next step
Next step: add one calm next step the timekeeper can try on the same pretend lab page:

Quiet option: adult reads the start scene and turn signal, and the writer fills only the after path blank: _____. **Take-home line:** place the lab page in the file box with the file-box label ready for later: _____.

Greenhouse Gear Garden Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: open the file box, add a blank garden page, and set a pencil beside a file-box label slip: _____.

Writer: make up a greenhouse gear helper and keep every gear, gate, and garden note pretend on paper: _____.



Greenhouse Gear Garden

Starting scene Start scene: write what the greenhouse helper is trying to sort with the pretend gear cards: _____ _____	Turn signal Turn signal: name the small paper sign that changes the helper's plan, such as a gear notch, gate tag, or vine mark: _____ _____
Before path Before path: write the helper's first plan before the turn signal appears on the page: _____ _____	After path After path: write the new plan the helper chooses after reading the turn signal: _____ _____
Character reaction Character reaction: write one line about how the helper reacts to the changed plan: _____ _____	Next step Next step: add one paper next step that keeps the greenhouse story moving gently: _____ _____
File-box label File-box label: write the short pretend label for this greenhouse gear turning point: _____ _____	

Quiet option: adult points to the turn signal line, and the writer fills only the character reaction blank: _____. Take-home line: tuck the greenhouse page into the file box with the before path and after path marked for later: _____.

Solar Oven Picnic Station Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place a file box, blank station page, pencil, and file-box label slip where the writer can reach them: _____.

Writer: invent a picnic station helper and use only pretend paper panels, notes, and station signs: _____.



Solar Oven Picnic Station

Starting scene

Start scene: write what the station helper is arranging on the pretend paper panel before the plan turns: _____.

Before path

Before path: write what the helper planned to do before the turn signal changed the page: _____.

Character reaction

Character reaction: write how the helper responds when the new path fits the station better: _____.

File-box label

File-box label: write the short pretend label for this station turning point: _____.

Turn signal

Turn signal: name the paper sign that tells the helper to change the plan, such as a sun card, shade mark, or folded tag: _____.

After path

After path: write the new paper path the helper follows after noticing the signal: _____.

Next step

Next step: add one gentle next step that belongs in the pretend picnic station story: _____.

Quiet option: adult reads the before path and after path, and the writer fills only the file-box label blank: _____. **Take-home line:** save the station page in the file box with one turn signal note clipped to the page: _____.

Orchard Pulley Post Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set one file box beside a blank orchard post page, pencil, and label strip before writing starts: _____.

Writer: invent an orchard post helper and keep the pulley, message cards, and turning point completely pretend: _____.



Orchard Pulley Post

Starting scene

Start scene: write what the orchard helper is carrying, sorting, or reading at the pulley post first: _____.

Before path

Before path: write the helper's first paper path before the pulley clue changes the plan: _____.

Character reaction

Character reaction: write how the helper reacts to the new pulley-post path: _____.

File-box label

File-box label: write the short pretend label for this orchard turning point: _____.

Turn signal

Turn signal: name the paper clue that changes the helper's plan, such as a ribbon mark, branch tag, or pulley arrow: _____.

After path

After path: write the new paper path the helper follows after the turn signal appears: _____.

Next step

Next step: add one next action the helper can write on the pretend orchard post page: _____.

Quiet option: adult circles the turn signal phrase, and the writer fills only the after path line: _____. **Take-home line:** file the orchard post page with the turning point label facing up for later: _____.

Revision River Ferry Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out the file box, a blank river ferry page, pencil, and file-box label slip for the paper turning point: _____.

Writer: invent a ferry guide, revision notes, and a made-up river crossing that exists only on the page: _____.



Revision River Ferry

Starting scene

Start scene: write what the ferry guide is revising, sorting, or carrying before the turning point arrives: _____.

Before path

Before path: write the guide's original paper path before the revision clue changes the plan: _____.

Character reaction

Character reaction: write how the ferry guide reacts when the revised path fits the page: _____.

File-box label

File-box label: write the short pretend label for this revision river turning point: _____.

Turn signal

Turn signal: name the revision clue that changes the ferry guide's plan, such as a margin arrow, ferry tag, or crossed note: _____.

After path

After path: write the new path the guide follows after the turn signal points to a better revision choice: _____.

Next step

Next step: add one thoughtful next step the guide can write after the turning point: _____.

Quiet option: adult rereads the turn signal, and the writer fills only the before path and after path blanks: _____. **Take-home line:** keep the ferry page in the file box with the file-box label and next step ready for later: _____.

Clue Label Tower Museum Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one file box, blank page, pencil, and this card beside a pretend tower-museum label stack: _____.

Writer: plan one invented tower-museum turning point on paper and keep every clue label made up with adult guidance: _____.



Starting scene Start scene: write where the fictional label keeper begins in the tower museum: _____.	Turn signal Turn signal: name the small paper clue that tells the scene is about to change: _____.
Before path Before path: write what the label keeper planned to do before the turn signal appeared: _____.	After path After path: write the new paper path the label keeper follows after noticing the signal: _____.
Character reaction Character reaction: show how the label keeper reacts with one calm thought, question, or action: _____.	Next step Next step: write the next page action that moves the tower-museum story forward: _____.
File-box label File-box label: write the broad pretend label for this turning point card: _____.	

Quiet option: fill only the start scene, turn signal, and file-box label first: _____.

Take-home line: keep the page in the file box and add one new after-path note later: _____.

Chapter Gate Greenhouse Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one file box, blank page, pencil, and this card beside a pretend greenhouse gate stack: _____.

Writer: draft one invented greenhouse turning point on paper and keep every gate detail pretend: _____.



Chapter Gate Greenhouse

Starting scene Start scene: write where the fictional gate sorter begins beside the greenhouse papers: _____.	Turn signal Turn signal: name the gate note, vine tag, or page corner that signals a change: _____.
Before path Before path: write what the gate sorter planned before the turn signal appeared: _____.	After path After path: write the new paper path the gate sorter follows once the signal is noticed: _____.
Character reaction Character reaction: show the gate sorter's calm thought, question, or action after the change: _____.	Next step Next step: write the next page action that carries the greenhouse story forward: _____.
File-box label File-box label: write the broad pretend label for this greenhouse turning point card: _____.	

Quiet option: complete only the start scene, turn signal, and file-box label first: _____.

Take-home line: tuck the page in the file box and add one new next-step note later: _____.

Margin Note Market Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one file box, blank page, pencil, and this card beside a pretend margin-note stall map: _____.

Writer: plan one invented market turning point on paper using only pretend notes, tags, and paths: _____.



Margin Note Market

Starting scene
Start scene: write where the fictional note keeper begins in the margin-note market:

Turn signal
Turn signal: name the margin note, paper tag, or path mark that signals a change: _____

Before path
Before path: write what the note keeper expected to do before the signal appeared:

After path
After path: write the new paper path the note keeper follows after reading the signal:

Character reaction
Character reaction: show the note keeper's calm thought, question, or action at the turning point:

Next step
Next step: write the next page action that moves the margin-note story forward: _____

File-box label
File-box label: write the broad pretend label for this market turning point card: _____

Quiet option: fill only the start scene, turn signal, and file-box label before adding paths: _____, **Take-home line:** keep the page in the file box and add one new before-path or after-path note later: _____.

Binding Day Boardwalk Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one file box, blank page, pencil, and this card beside a pretend boardwalk page stack: _____.

Writer: draft one invented boardwalk turning point on paper and keep every binding-day detail made up: _____.



Binding Day Boardwalk

Starting scene
Start scene: write where the fictional binding helper begins along the boardwalk papers:

Turn signal
Turn signal: name the ribbon tag, page marker, or boardwalk note that signals a change:

Before path
Before path: write what the binding helper planned before the signal changed the page:

After path
After path: write the new paper path the binding helper follows after seeing the signal:

Character reaction
Character reaction: show the binding helper's calm thought, question, or action when the path changes:

Next step
Next step: write the next page action that carries the boardwalk story forward: _____.

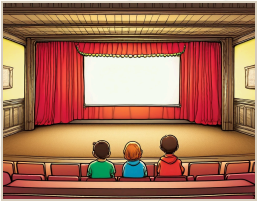
File-box label
File-box label: write the broad pretend label for this boardwalk turning point card: _____.

Quiet option: write only the start scene, turn signal, and file-box label for now: _____. Take-home line: place the page in the file box and add one new character-reaction line later: _____.

Index Card Theater Club Story Turning Point Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one file box, blank page, pencil, and this card beside a pretend theater-club index card stack: _____.

Writer: plan one invented theater-club turning point on paper and keep every card detail pretend: _____.



Index Card Theater Club

Starting scene Start scene: write where the fictional card keeper begins in the theater club: _____.	Turn signal Turn signal: name the index card, curtain tab, or note mark that signals a change: _____.
Before path Before path: write what the card keeper planned before the turn signal appeared: _____.	After path After path: write the new paper path the card keeper follows after noticing the signal: _____.
Character reaction Character reaction: show the card keeper's calm thought, question, or action when the plan changes: _____.	Next step Next step: write the next page action that moves the theater-club story forward: _____.
File-box label File-box label: write the broad pretend label for this theater-club turning point card: _____.	

Quiet option: fill only the start scene, turn signal, and file-box label before adding more: _____.

Take-home line: keep the page in the file box and add one new next-step note later: _____.